

Trip Guide: East Coast & West Coast USA

Boston, Massachusetts

Boston's Freedom Trail is a 2.5-mile walking path past 16 historic sites, including the Old North Church, Paul Revere's House, and the Massachusetts State House. It's the best way to see Revolutionary War history in the city.

Fenway Park, home of the Boston Red Sox, is one of the oldest baseball stadiums in the United States, built in 1912. Stadium tours are available even on non-game days.

The Boston Public Garden and adjacent Boston Common offer swan boat rides, walking paths, and green space right in the middle of downtown Boston, a relaxing break from the city.

The Museum of Fine Arts and the New England Aquarium are Boston's top museum and family attractions, with the aquarium featuring a giant ocean tank and penguin exhibit.

New York City, New York

Central Park is an 843-acre green space in the middle of Manhattan, with walking paths, a zoo, a boating lake, and open lawns, a favorite for locals and tourists alike.

The Statue of Liberty and Ellis Island are reachable by ferry from Battery Park, and offer a look at New York's immigration history.

Times Square is famous for its bright billboards, Broadway theaters, and 24-hour energy, one of the most visited tourist spots in the world.

The Metropolitan Museum of Art and the Empire State Building observation deck are two of New York's most iconic sightseeing stops.

Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

The Liberty Bell and Independence Hall sit side by side in Independence National Historical Park, marking the birthplace of the Declaration of Independence and the U.S. Constitution.

Reading Terminal Market is a historic indoor market with dozens of food stalls, from Pennsylvania Dutch baked goods to Philly cheesesteaks.

The Philadelphia Museum of Art is famous for its grand entrance staircase, made iconic by the movie Rocky, and houses one of the largest art collections in the country.

Fairmount Park, one of the largest urban park systems in the U.S., offers riverside trails, historic mansions, and the Philadelphia Zoo.

Washington, D.C.

The National Mall stretches between the U.S. Capitol and the Lincoln Memorial, lined with monuments, memorials, and reflecting pools.

The Smithsonian museums, including the National Air and Space Museum and the National Museum of Natural History, are free to enter and among the most visited museums in the world.

The White House and the U.S. Capitol Building offer public tours (with advance reservations) for a look at the seats of American government.

The Tidal Basin, especially during the National Cherry Blossom Festival each spring, draws large crowds to see the Jefferson Memorial framed by blooming trees.

Miami, Florida

South Beach is known for its wide sandy beaches, turquoise water, and the Art Deco Historic District, home to colorful 1930s buildings along Ocean Drive.

Little Havana's Calle Ocho is the cultural heart of Miami's Cuban community, with cafecito windows, cigar shops, and live music.

Everglades National Park, a short drive from the city, offers airboat tours through wetlands home to alligators, manatees, and hundreds of bird species.

Wynwood Walls is an outdoor museum of large-scale street art and murals, surrounded by galleries, breweries, and design studios.

Los Angeles, California

The Hollywood Walk of Fame and the TCL Chinese Theatre are the heart of Hollywood, with over 2,700 stars honoring entertainment icons.

Griffith Observatory, perched in the hills above the city, offers free telescope viewing and sweeping views of the Hollywood Sign and downtown LA skyline.

Santa Monica Pier features an oceanfront amusement park, an aquarium, and direct beach access at the official end of Route 66.

The Getty Center is a hilltop art museum with an extensive European art collection, dramatic architecture, and gardens overlooking the city.

San Francisco, California

The Golden Gate Bridge is San Francisco's most iconic landmark, best viewed from Battery Spencer across the bay or by walking or biking across it.

Alcatraz Island, the former federal prison, offers popular ferry tours departing from Pier 33, with audio tours narrated by former inmates and guards.

Fisherman's Wharf and Pier 39 are known for fresh seafood, shopping, and a colony of wild sea lions that gather on the docks.

San Francisco's cable cars and the steep, winding curves of Lombard Street are two of the city's most photographed attractions.

Seattle, Washington

Pike Place Market is a century-old public market overlooking Puget Sound, famous for its fishmongers, flower stalls, and the original Starbucks store.

The Space Needle, built for the 1962 World's Fair, offers a rotating glass floor observation deck with panoramic views of the city and Mount Rainier.

Chihuly Garden and Glass displays the colorful blown-glass sculptures of artist Dale Chihuly, right at the base of the Space Needle.

Ferries from Seattle's waterfront cross Puget Sound to islands like Bainbridge, offering an easy half-day trip with skyline views on the return.

Portland, Oregon

Powell's City of Books is one of the largest independent bookstores in the world, taking up an entire city block in downtown Portland.

The Portland Japanese Garden is considered one of the most authentic Japanese gardens outside of Japan, spread across serene, landscaped acres.

Portland's food truck pods, clustered in gravel lots across downtown, serve everything from Thai street food to gourmet grilled cheese.

Multnomah Falls, a short drive along the Columbia River Gorge, is a 620-foot waterfall reachable by an easy paved trail.

San Diego, California

The USS Midway Museum, a retired aircraft carrier docked on the waterfront, lets visitors explore flight decks, aircraft, and crew quarters.

Balboa Park is home to the San Diego Zoo and more than a dozen museums, all set among Spanish Colonial Revival architecture and gardens.

La Jolla Cove is known for its calm waters, sea lions lounging on the rocks, and popular snorkeling and kayaking spots.

The Gaslamp Quarter is San Diego's historic downtown nightlife district, with Victorian-era buildings now housing restaurants, bars, and live music venues.